



7 DAYS · 45-75 MIN A DAY

The **First-Garment** Plan

A day-by-day schedule to finish your first piece in one week: exactly what to do, how long it takes and how you know you're done.

- ✓ Day-by-day tasks, time and checklist
- ✓ Starts with the easiest pattern in your Bible: W061 Elastic-Waist Skirt
- ✓ Printable 7-day tracker + size tables
- ✓ Your next 8 garments, from easy to your first shirt

The plan

83% of first garments never get finished — not for lack of skill, but because nobody tells you what to do tonight. This plan tells you. One small task a day, 45–75 minutes, and on Day 7 you're wearing it.

Your first garment: W061 · Elastic-Waist Skirt (level: Beginner). Why this one: only straight seams, no zipper, no buttons, no fitting drama — the elastic adjusts to your waist. You learn the 5 skills every garment uses: measuring, cutting on grain, sewing a seam, finishing a seam, hemming.

Fabric: quilting cotton, poplin or chambray (not slippery, not stretchy). **Amount:** 1.6 m / 1 3/4 yd at 150 cm / 60 in wide (all sizes); at 115 cm / 45 in wide 1.6 m / 1 3/4 yd (sizes 34–46) or 1.9 m / 2 yd (48–56).

Needle: Universal 80/12 · **Stitch:** 2.5 mm · **Seam allowance:** 1.5 cm / 5/8 in.

Prefer something else? The same 7 days work for **W081 Elastic-Waist Shorts** (add the crotch seam on Day 4) or, for a man, **M044 Lounge Pants**. Same fabric, same notions.

Rules of the week

1. Same time every day (put it in your calendar). Stop when the day's task is done — even if you want to keep going.
2. Missed a day? Don't skip: do that day tomorrow. The plan moves with you.
3. Stuck? Ask your Private Sewing Coach right then: tell it the pattern (W061), the day and what you see.
4. Press after every seam. Pressing is half of sewing.

What you need

- ☐ Sewing machine + Universal 80/12 needle (new)
- ☐ Fabric (see above), all-purpose polyester thread
- ☐ Elastic 3 cm / 1 1/4 in wide, waist – 8 cm long
- ☐ Fabric scissors + paper scissors, pins or pattern weights, tape measure, chalk/washable marker
- ☐ Iron + ironing board, a safety pin, clear tape for the pattern

DAY 1 → DAY 7

Day by day

Tick every box. Each day ends with a clear "done when".

Day 1 Measure, choose your size & shop

🕒 45–60 min

- ☐ Measure yourself in underwear, tape snug but not tight: waist (narrowest point), hips (fullest point, about 20 cm / 8 in below the waist). Write both in cm and inches.
- ☐ Choose your size by your HIP for this skirt (see the size table at the back). Between two sizes? Take the bigger one — the elastic takes care of the waist.
- ☐ Open pattern W061 Elastic-Waist Skirt in your Bible and write down the fabric amount for your size.
- ☐ Buy: 1.6 m / 1 3/4 yd of quilting cotton, poplin or chambray 150 cm / 60 in wide (at 115 cm / 45 in wide: 1.6 m / 1 3/4 yd for sizes 34–46, 1.9 m / 2 yd for sizes 48–56 — exact numbers in the W061 booklet's yardage table), elastic 3 cm / 1 1/4 in (your waist – 8 cm), matching all-purpose polyester thread, a Universal 80/12 needle, a safety pin.

Done when: You have your size, your fabric and your notions in a bag. Nothing else.

Day 2 Pre-wash, print & tape the pattern

🕒 60 min (+ the wash cycle)

- ☐ Zigzag the cut ends of the fabric and wash + dry it like you'll wash the skirt (cotton shrinks 3–5%).
- ☐ Print W061 at 100% / "actual size" (never "fit to page") on Letter, A4 or A3 — or the tiled A4 version.
- ☐ Measure the TEST SQUARE: it must be exactly 10 cm / 4 in. If not, check the printer scale and reprint.
- ☐ Tape the tiles following the assembly map (match the letters/numbers at the edges). Cut out your size along its line with paper scissors.

Done when: Test square checked, pattern taped and cut, fabric washed and dry.

Day 3**Press, lay out & cut**

🕒 60 min

- ☐ Press the fabric flat (cotton, steam). Fold it selvage to selvage, right sides together.
- ☐ Place the pieces following the cutting layout: grainline arrows parallel to the selvage (measure both ends of the arrow to the selvage — same number). Center front on the fold if marked.
- ☐ Pin or use weights. Cut with fabric scissors in long, smooth strokes. Cut notches OUT (little triangles) or snip 3 mm into the allowance.
- ☐ Mark pocket placement and hem line with chalk or a washable marker. Keep scraps for practice.

Done when: All pieces cut, notches marked, scraps saved.

Day 4**Machine warm-up + side seams (and pockets)**

🕒 60–75 min

- ☐ Thread the machine, new Universal 80/12 needle, stitch 2.5 mm, tension 4. Sew 3 test lines on a double scrap at 1.5 cm / 5/8 in — use the plate guide.
- ☐ Practice a seam finish on the scrap: zigzag 3–4 mm wide × 2 mm long, or serge.
- ☐ If your version has in-seam pockets: sew each pocket bag to the front and back at the side seam (1 cm), press toward the pocket, understitch.
- ☐ Sew the side seams right sides together at 1.5 cm, backstitch at both ends (pivot around the pockets). Finish the seams, press them open or toward the back.

Done when: The skirt is a tube with side seams sewn, finished and pressed.

Day 5**Waistband casing + elastic**

🕒 60 min

- ☐ Fold the top edge 1 cm / 3/8 in to the wrong side and press; fold again 3.8 cm / 1 1/2 in (elastic width + 0.8 cm) and press. Pin.
- ☐ Edge-stitch the casing close to the lower fold all around, leaving a 5 cm / 2 in opening at the back.
- ☐ Cut the elastic at your waist – 8 cm / 3 in. Pin a safety pin to one end, thread it through the casing; pin the other end to the skirt so it doesn't disappear.
- ☐ Overlap the elastic ends 2 cm, zigzag them together in a box. Close the opening. Spread the gathers evenly and stitch in the ditch at the side seams to stop the elastic twisting.

Done when: You can pull the skirt on and the elastic doesn't twist.

Day 6**Try on, adjust & hem**

⌚ 45–60 min

- ☐ Try it on with the shoes you'll wear. Check: waist comfortable (if tight, open the casing and let out 2 cm of elastic), side seams hang straight (Fit-Fix Library, Fix 24).
- ☐ Mark the hem length from the floor all around (a friend + a ruler, or a hem marker). Typical: knee = 58–60 cm / 23 in from the waist for a 1.60 m / 5'3" woman.
- ☐ Press up 1 cm, then 2.5–3 cm (double-fold hem). Pin every 10 cm.
- ☐ Stitch the hem from the wrong side close to the fold. Press.

Done when: The skirt is wearable. Seriously — it's done.

Day 7**Finish, press, photograph & plan the next one**

⌚ 30–45 min

- ☐ Trim all thread tails, check every seam for skipped stitches, press the whole skirt (press cloth on any topstitching).
- ☐ Take 3 photos: front, side, back — in daylight. Compare with the Fit-Fix Library and write any change on your paper pattern with today's date.
- ☐ Write what you learned in the tracker (tension, stitch, what you'd do differently).
- ☐ Pick your next garment from the ladder below and buy the fabric this week, while your hands remember.

Done when: You wear it. You tell someone "I made this".

PRINT ME

My 7-day tracker

Stick it next to your machine.

My garment: _____ Size: _____ Start date: ____ / ____ / ____

My measurements: waist _____ cm / in · hips _____ cm / in · bust _____ cm / in

Day	Date	Done	Time · notes
Day 1 · Measure, choose your size & shop		☐	
Day 2 · Pre-wash, print & tape the pattern		☐	
Day 3 · Press, lay out & cut		☐	
Day 4 · Machine warm-up + side seams (and pockets)		☐	
Day 5 · Waistband casing + elastic		☐	
Day 6 · Try on, adjust & hem		☐	
Day 7 · Finish, press, photograph & plan the next one		☐	

What I learned	What I'll do differently next time

REFERENCE

Size tables & your next garments

Body measurements in cm / inches. Choose tops by bust/chest, skirts and pants by hips.

Women • EU 34–56

Size	Bust	Hips	Waist
34 • XS	80 / 31.5	88 / 34.75	62 / 24.5
36 • S	84 / 33	92 / 36.25	66 / 26
38 • M	88 / 34.75	96 / 37.75	70 / 27.5
40 • M-L	92 / 36.25	100 / 39.25	74 / 29.25
42 • L	96 / 37.75	104 / 41	78 / 30.75
44 • XL	100 / 39.25	108 / 42.5	82 / 32.25
46 • XL-2XL	106 / 41.75	114 / 45	88 / 34.75
48 • 2XL	112 / 44	120 / 47.25	94 / 37
50 • 3XL	118 / 46.5	126 / 49.5	100 / 39.25
52 • 3XL-4XL	124 / 48.75	132 / 52	106 / 41.75
54 • 4XL	130 / 51.25	138 / 54.25	112 / 44
56 • 5XL	136 / 53.5	144 / 56.75	118 / 46.5

Men • EU 44–56

Size	Chest	Hips	Waist
44 • XS	88 / 34.75	90 / 35.5	76 / 30
46 • S	92 / 36.25	94 / 37	80 / 31.5
48 • M	96 / 37.75	98 / 38.5	84 / 33
50 • L	100 / 39.25	102 / 40.25	88 / 34.75
52 • XL	104 / 41	106 / 41.75	92 / 36.25
54 • 2XL	110 / 43.25	112 / 44	98 / 38.5
56 • 3XL	116 / 45.75	118 / 46.5	104 / 41

Your skill ladder · the next 8

ID	Pattern	Level	What it teaches
W061	Elastic-Waist Skirt	Beginner	your first garment: straight seams, a casing, a hem
W081	Elastic-Waist Shorts	Beginner	same skills + crotch seam
M044	Lounge Pants	Beginner	for him: same skills, drawcord
W046	Boxy Tee	Beginner	first knit: ballpoint needle, neckband
W035	Sleeveless Shell Top	Easy	facings, darts, a button loop
W054	A-Line Skirt	Easy	darts, invisible zipper, waistband
W044	Basic Crew Tee	Easy	sleeves on a knit
W037	Camp-Collar Shirt	Intermediate	collar, buttons — your first shirt